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## Hollow body fishing lure, hook and accessory for the same


### Abstract

Disclosed herein are fishing lures and replacement hook assembly kits for the same. In one example, a single hook assembly is provided that includes a single hook, and first and second stays. The single hook has a shank terminating at an eye, and a bend connecting the shank to a point. The bend and the shank both reside a reference plane. The first and second stays each have an elongated body. The elongated body of the first stay disposed on a first side of the reference plane and the elongated body of the second stay disposed on a first side of the reference plane. The elongated bodies have a resiliency sufficient to substantially return to an original position after deflecting the second end against the single hook.



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## Background/Summary

BACKGROUND
Field
(1) Embodiments of the present disclosure generally relate to fishing lures, and more particularly, to a hollow body fishing lure, and replacement hook and accessory for the same
Description of the Related Art
(2) Artificial fishing lures may be presented in many different ways, often depending on the target species, water temperature, and structure to which the fish are holding. One popular type of artificial fishing lure is a hollow body top water lure. These hollow body fishing lures are commonly used to imitate a frog, but also come in designs that imitate ducks, birds, rats, mice, and other animals or amphibians that swim on top of the water. Common to generally all of these hollow body fishing lures is a weedless design that features a double hook. The points of the double hook are shielded by the sides of the hollow body, allowing the lure to be used in brush, lily pads and other grassy areas with fouling. When the hollow body is struck (i.e., bitten) by a fish, the hollow body collapses to expose the points of the double hook.
(3) FIGS. **1** and **2** depict schematic top and bottom views of one example of a conventional hollow body fishing lure **100**. FIG. **3** is a schematic cutaway side view of the conventional hollow body fishing lure **100** illustrated in FIGS. **1** and **2**. The hollow body fishing lure **100** includes a hollow body **102** having a double hook assembly **104**. The hollow body fishing lure **100** may also include one or more appendages **140**. The appendages **140** may be configured to imitate feet, legs, tails and the like. In FIG. **1**, two appendages **140** are shown in the form of tassels.
(4) The hollow body **102** is generally fabricated from a flexible resilient material, such as silicone, or other soft plastic. The hollow body **102** generally can collapse with when bitten by a fish, then return to its original form once the force from the bite is removed. The hollow body **102** may be configured to imitate a frog, a duck, a bird, a rat, a mouse, a rodent, a spider, snake, salamander, lizard, or other animal, insect or amphibian, without limitation.
(5) The double hook assembly **104** is inserted through the hollow body **102**. The double hook assembly **104** includes a double hook **106** having an eye **108** connected with a back eye **132** of a spacer **110**. A link **134** of the spacer **110** extends from the back eye **132** and passes through an aperture **112** formed in the front **114** of the hollow body **102**, terminating at a front eye **136**. The front eye **136** is used to attach fishing line (not shown) to the lure **100**. As the front and back eyes **132**, **136** of the spacer **110** are generally larger than the diameter of the aperture **112**, the spacer **110** keeps the double hook **106** from moving fore and aft within the hollow body **102**. The eye **108** of the double hook **106** is formed at the ends of two shanks **116**, **118**. Each shank **116**, **118** extends from the eye **108** to a bend **120** that terminates at a point **122** just after a barb **124**. The bend **120** generally turns upward such that the points **122** of the double hook **106** are positioned proximate a

top **126** of the hollow body **102**.

(6) As more clearly illustrated in FIGS. **2** and **3**, the two shanks **116**, **118** pass from an interior volume **208** through an aperture **202** formed through the bottom **210** near the back **204** of the hollow body **102** such that the point **122** connected to the first shank **116** is disposed on one side of an exterior **206** of the hollow body **102** while other the point **122** connected to the second shank **118** is disposed on the opposite exterior side of the hollow body **102**.

(7) The soft hollow body **102** easily collapses when bitten a striking fish (shown by arrows **402** in FIG. **4**), exposing the points **122** of the double hook **106** which can be driven into the fish's mouth, as shown in FIG. **4**. Although the double hook design of the lure **100** has good weedless functionality, the two points **122** of the double hook **106** requires double the amount of force to drive the points **122** into a fish's mouth as compared to other types of lures that use a single hook. As such, lures having double hooks generally have lower hook up ratios as compared to single hook lures.

(8) Therefore, a need exists for an improved hollow body fishing lure.

SUMMARY

(9) Embodiments of the present disclosure generally relate to a hollow body fishing lure, and replacement hook and accessory for the same. The hollow body fishing lure may be configured to imitate a frog, a duck, a bird, a rat, a mouse, a rodent, a spider, snake, salamander, lizard, or other animal, insect, amphibian, or other top water creature eaten by fish.

(10) In one example, a single hook assembly is provided that includes a single hook, and first and second stays. The single hook has a shank terminating at an eye, and a bend connecting the shank to a point. The bend and the shank both reside a reference plane. The first and second stays each have an elongated body. The elongated body of the first stay disposed on a first side of the reference plane and the elongated body of the second stay disposed on a first side of the reference plane. The elongated bodies have a resiliency sufficient to substantially return to an original position after deflecting the second end against the single hook.

(11) In some examples, the first stay and the second stay are symmetrical relative to the first reference plane.

(12) In some examples, the first stay and the second stay are sufficiently rigid to support the first reference plane of the single hook assembly in a substantially vertical orientation when the first and second stays are placed on a horizontal surface with the point disposed over the shank of the single hook.

(13) In some examples, the second ends of the first and second stays do not extend beyond a total length of the single hook when deflected against the single hook. In other examples, the second ends of the first and second stays do extend past a barb of the single hook when deflected against the single hook. In still other examples, the second ends of the first and second stays do not overlap the bend of the single hook when deflected against the single hook.

(14) In some examples, the single hook has a size from 1/0 to 6/0.

(15) In yet another example, a single hook assembly provided that includes provided that includes a single hook, a spacer, and first and second stays. The single hook has a shank terminating at an eye, and a bend connecting the shank to a point. The bend and the shank both reside a reference plane. The single hook has a size from 2/0 to 6/0. The spacer has a first eye and a second eye connected by a link. The first eye is connected to the eye of the hook. The first stay haves an elongated body. The elongated body has a first end connected to the single hook and a second end extending away from the elongated body towards the bend of the single hook. The elongated body is disposed on a first side of the first reference plane and has a resiliency sufficient to substantially return to an original position after deflecting the second end against the single hook. The second stay also has an elongated body. The elongated body of the second stay has a first end connected to the single hook and a second end extending away from the elongated body towards the bend of the single hook. The elongated body of the second stay is disposed on a second side of the first reference

plane. The elongated body of the second stay has a resiliency sufficient to substantially return to an original position of the elongated body of the second stay after deflecting the second end of the second stay against the single hook. The first stay and the second stay are symmetrical relative to the first reference plane. The second ends of the first and second stays do extend past a barb of the single hook when deflected against the single hook. The first stay and the second stay are also sufficiently rigid to support the first reference plane of the single hook assembly in a substantially vertical orientation when the first and second stays are placed on a horizontal surface with the point disposed over the shaft of the single hook.
(16) In some examples, the first and second stays are fabricated from a polymer, and each of the first and second stays have a sectional area great than or equal to a sectional area of the shank.
(17) In yet another example, a hollow body fishing lure hook replacement kit is provided. The kit includes a single hook assembly disposed in a packaging container. The single hook assembly includes stays as described herein.
(18) In some examples, the hollow body fishing lure hook replacement kit also includes an adhesive backed weed guard disposed in the container. The adhesive backed weed guard includes a plurality of projections extending a distance from a first side of a pad. The distance is at least half a diameter of the shank and less than 2.5 times the diameter of the shank. The adhesive backed weed guard also including an adhesive disposed on a second side of the pad and a peel-away backing disposed over the adhesive.
(19) In some examples, the each of the plurality of projections of the adhesive backed weed guard further includes a proximal end coupled to a distal end by an elongated shaft. The proximal end is coupled to the pad. The distal end has a cap that overhangs the shaft. The cap may optionally have a sectional area greater than a sectional area of the shaft of the projection
(20) In yet another example, a hollow body fishing lure is provided. The hollow body fishing lure includes a hollow body, a hook, and a weed guard. The hollow body has a first aperture formed through a front end of the hollow body and a second aperture formed through a back end or bottom of the hollow body. The hook is disposed though the second aperture such that a point of the hook is disposed on an exterior of the hollow body and a shank of the hook is disposed within an interior of the hollow body. The weed guard is disposed on the exterior of the hollow body. The weed guard includes a plurality of projections receiving the point of the hook therebetween and extending a distance beyond the point when the hollow body is in a non-deformed state. The hollow body is sufficiently flexible to allow the weed guard to move clear of the point of the hook when the hollow body deformed in a direction away from the point of the hook and sufficiently resilient to return to the non-deformed state in which the point of the hook is disposed between the projections of the weed guard.

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## Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS
(1) So that the manner in which the above recited features of the present disclosure can be understood in detail, a more particular description of the disclosure, briefly summarized above, may be had by reference to embodiments, some of which are illustrated in the appended drawings. It is to be noted, however, that the appended drawings illustrate only typical embodiments of this disclosure and are therefore not to be considered limiting of its scope, for the disclosure may admit to other equally effective embodiments.
(2) FIG. **1** is a schematic top view of a conventional hollow body fishing lure.
(3) FIG. **2** is a schematic bottom view of the conventional hollow body fishing lure illustrated in FIG. **1**.
(4) FIG. **3** is a schematic cutaway side view of the conventional hollow body fishing lure illustrated

in FIG. **1**.
(5) FIG. **4** is a schematic side view of the conventional hollow body fishing lure illustrated in FIG. **1** with the body being deformed, for example, by a fish strike.
(6) FIG. **5** is a top view of one example of a single hook assembly that may be used as a replacement to a conventional double hook assembly of a conventional hollow body fishing lure illustrated in FIGS. **1-3**, or in a hollow body fishing lure illustrated in FIG. **7** and the like.
(7) FIG. **6** is a side view of the single hook assembly.
(8) FIG. **7** is a schematic top view of a hollow body fishing lure having a single hook assembly.
(9) FIG. **8** is a schematic bottom view of the hollow body fishing lure illustrated in FIG. **7**.
(10) FIG. **9** is a schematic sectional side view of the hollow body fishing lure illustrated in FIG. **7**.
(11) FIG. **10** is an enlarged partial top view of a portion of the hollow body fishing lure illustrated in FIG. **7** showing a point of the single hook disposed within an exemplary weed guard.
(12) FIG. **11** is a sectional side view of a portion of the hollow body fishing lure illustrated in FIG. **7** showing the point of the single hook disposed within the weed guard.
(13) FIG. **12** is a sectional side view of a portion of the hollow body fishing lure illustrated in FIG. **7** showing the point of the single hook clear of the weed guard when the body is deformed, for example, by the strike of a fish.
(14) FIG. **13** is a sectional view of one example of a weed guard that may be utilized with a hollow body or other type of fishing lure.
(15) FIG. **14** is a single hook replacement kit that includes a single hook assembly and a weed guard.
(16) FIG. **15** is a side view of another example of a single hook assembly that may be used as a replacement to a conventional double hook assembly of a conventional hollow body fishing lure illustrated in FIGS. **1-3**, or in a hollow body fishing lure illustrated in FIG. **7** and the like.
(17) To facilitate understanding, identical reference numerals have been used, where possible, to designate identical elements that are common to the figures. It is contemplated that elements disclosed in one embodiment may be beneficially utilized in other embodiments without specific recitation.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(18) Disclosed herein are fishing lures and replacement single hook assemblies for the same. The single hook assembly described herein utilizes a single hook for improved hook sets as compared to traditional double hook designs. For example, the single hook assembly is advantageously configured to allow the single hook assembly to replace double hook assemblies commonly utilized in convention hollow body fishing lures, such as but not limited to the hollow body fishing lure described above with reference to FIGS. **1-4**. The single hook assembly utilizes flexible stays that maintain a desired orientation of the hook, while also enabling the hook assembly to pass through apertures formed in the hollow body that allows the shank of the hook to exit the interior of the hollow body. The single hook assembly may also be packaged as a kit that optionally includes an adhesive backed weed guard. The adhesive backed weed guard enables a hollow body fishing lure originally designed for use with a double hook to maintain its weedless properties once the double hook is replaced with a single hook.
(19) FIGS. **5** and **6** are top and side views of one example of a single hook assembly **500** that may be used as a replacement to a conventional double hook assembly of a conventional hollow body fishing lure, such as but not limited to the conventional double hook assembly **104** of a conventional hollow body fishing lure **100** illustrated in FIGS. **1-4**, among others. The single hook assembly **500** may also be used as original equipment in other lures.
(20) The single hook assembly **500** includes a single hook **506** and at least two stays, shown in FIG. **5** as a first stay **570** and a second stay **572**. The single hook assembly **500** may also include an optional spacer **110**. The single hook **506** includes an eye **532**, a shank **534**, a bend **536** and a point **538**. A barb **602** is located proximate the point **538**. The eye **532** and bend **536** are disposed at

opposite ends of the shank **534**. The hook **506** has a length **560** defined between the farthest portions of the eye **532** and the bend **536**, as illustrated in FIGS. **5** and **6**. The bend **536** and shank **534** reside in a first reference plane **502**. The first reference plane **502** is generally in the X/Y plane.

(21) The first and second stays **570**, **572** of single hook assembly **500** are disposed on opposite sides of the first reference plane **502**. The first and second stays **570**, **572** may be arranged as an arrow pointing towards the eye **532** of the hook **530**. The first stay **570** includes an elongated body **512** having a first end **510** and second end **514**. The first end **510** is coupled to the shank **534** of the hook **530** near the eye **532**. The elongated body **512** extends from the first end **510** away from the eye **532** towards the bend **536** of the hook **530** to the second end **514**. The elongated body **512** also extends from the first end **510** away from the shank **534** of the hook **530** to the second end **514**. The second end **514** of the elongated body **512** is spaced a distance **564** in the Z direction away from the shank **534** of the hook **530** to the second end **514**. The distance **564** may be, but is not limited to, ⅜ to about 1.0 inches.

(22) The similar to the first stay **570**, the second stay **572** includes an elongated body **522** having a first end **520** and second end **524**. The first end **520** is coupled to the shank **534** of the hook **530** near the eye **532**. The elongated body **522** extends from the first end **520** away from the eye **532** towards the bend **536** of the hook **530** to the second end **524**. The elongated body **522** also extends from the first end **520** away from the shank **534** of the hook **530** to the second end **524**. The second end **524** of the elongated body **522** is spaced a distance **564** in the Z direction away from the shank **534** of the hook **530** to the second end **524**. The distance **564** may be, but is not limited to, ⅜ to about 1.0 inches.

(23) The first ends **510**, **520** of the first and second stays **570**, **572** may be coupled to a common base **516**. The base **516**, when used, provides a common attachment point for the first and second stays **570**, **572** to the shank **534** of the hook **530**. In one example, the base **516** and the stays **570**, **572** are formed from a contiguous mass of material. For example, the base **516** and the stays **570**, **572** may be overmolded, 3-D printed, snapped-on, adhered or otherwise affixed to the shank **534** as a single one piece element. In other examples, the base **516** and the stays **570**, **572** may be two or more separate piece elements. Additionally, the stays **570**, **572** may be separately or jointly connected to the shank **534** of the hook **530** without a common base **516**.

(24) As discussed above, the elongated body **512** of the first stay **570** and the elongated body **522** of the second stay **572** are disposed on opposite sides of the first reference plane **502**. The elongated body **512** of the first stay **570** and the elongated body **522** of the second stay **572** may be disposed in an orientation that is symmetrical relative to the reference plane **502** and relative to the shank **534**. In one example, the elongated body **512** of the first stay **570** and the elongated body **522** of the second stay **572** are disposed in a second reference plane (not illustrated) that has an orientation perpendicular to the reference plane **502**. The second reference plane (i.e., the X/Z plane in FIGS. **5** and **6**) includes the shank **534**. In other example, the second ends **514**, **524** of the first and second stays **570**, **572** are symmetrically disposed below the second reference plane (i.e., on the opposite side the shank **534** relative to the point **538** of the hook **530**).

(25) The elongated bodies **512**, **522** are also sized to allow the hook **530** and stays **570**, **572** to pass through the aperture **202** of the hollow body **102** (as later shown in FIG. **8**). For example, the end **514**, **524** of each elongated body **512**, **522** is generally disposed at a distance **562** from a front of the eye **532** of the hook **530**. The distance **562** is shorter than the length **560** of the hook **530** to ensure the stays **570**, **572** can pass completely through the aperture **202** and completely into the interior volume **208** of the hollow body **102**. In other examples, the distance **562** is shorter a distance **604** defined between the front of the eye **532** of the hook **530** and the point **538** of the hook **530**. In other examples, the distance **562** is shorter a distance **606** defined between the front of the eye **532** of the hook **530** and the barb **602** of the hook **530**.

(26) The elongated bodies **512**, **522** of the first and second stays **570**, **572** are formed from a resilient material, such as spring steel, stainless steel, or resilient polymer. The resilient material of

the elongated bodies **512**, **522** allow the second ends **514**, **524** of the bodies **512**, **522** to be defected against the shank **534**, then return substantially to its original position, that is, to at least 90% of its original position, when in a new unused condition.

(27) The material of the elongated bodies **512**, **522** of the first and second stays **570**, **572** is also sufficiently rigid enough to support the bend **536** of the single hook **530** in a substantially vertical orientation (i.e., the first reference plane **502** is disposed in the X/Y plane) when the first and second stays **570**, **572** are placed on a horizontal surface (i.e., the X/Z plane) with the point **538** disposed over the shank **534** of the single hook **530**.

(28) The rigidity and resiliency of the material of the elongated bodies **512**, **522** of the first and second stays **570**, **572** are generally selected to allow the stays **570**, **572** to flex and pass through the aperture **202** of the hollow body **102**, then to spring outwards once the second ends **514**, **524** of the elongated bodies **512**, **522** are completely within the interior volume **208** of the hollow body **102**. Once within the hollow body **102**, the spread orientation of first and second stays **570**, **572** against the sides and bottom walls of the hollow body **102** supports the hook **530** in an upright position (i.e., in the X/Y plane) which promotes hook penetration when a fish strikes the lure by maintaining the point **538** of the hook **530** clear of the body **102**.

(29) FIGS. **7**, **8** and **9** depict the single hook assembly **500** disposed within one example of a hollow body fishing lure **700**. The hollow body fishing lure **700** includes a hollow body **102** as described above. In one example, the hollow body fishing lure **100** may be converted to the hollow body fishing lure **700** by replacing the double hook assembly **104** of the hollow body fishing lure **100** with the single hook assembly **500**. In other examples, the hollow body fishing lure **700** may be manufactured with the single hook assembly **500** as original equipment (e.g., the original hook).

(30) The hollow body **102** is configured as described above with reference to FIGS. **1**, **2** and **3**. The hollow body **102** may be configured to imitate a frog, a duck, a bird, a rat, a mouse, a rodent, a spider, snake, salamander, lizard, or other animal, insect, amphibian, or other top water creature commonly eaten by fish.

(31) Turning first to the top view of the hollow body fishing lure **700** depicted in FIG. **7**, the single hook assembly **500** is illustrated disposed within the hollow body **102** with the shank **534** of the single hook **530** passing through the aperture **202**. The point **538** of the single hook **530** is disposed over the top **126** of the hollow body **102**. The stays **570**, **572** extending symmetrically from each side of the shank **534** support the point **538** of the single hook **530** aligned in the center of the hollow body fishing lure **700**. The stays **570**, **572** generally keep the point **538** of the single hook **530** from falling over to the side of the lure **700** where penetration into a fish upon a strike will not be as effective. Moreover, the stays **570**, **572** keep the point **538** of the single hook **530** engaged with a weed guard **710** disposed on the top **126** of the hollow body **102**.

(32) Referring now to the bottom view of the hollow body fishing lure **700** depicted in FIG. **8** and the cutaway side view of the hollow body fishing lure **700** depicted in FIG. **9**, the shank **534** of the single hook **530** passes through the aperture **202** such that the bend **536** and point **538** of the hook **530** are disposed on the exterior **206** of the hollow body **102** while the stays **570**, **572** of the hook assembly **500** and eye **532** of the hook **530** are disposed within the interior volume **208** of the hollow body **102**. The spacer **110** of the hook assembly **500** extends through the aperture **112** disposed in the front **114** of the hollow body **102** to limit the fore and aft movement of the hook **530** within the hollow body **102**, which also beneficially maintains the point **538** of the hook **530** shielded by the weed guard **710**, making the lure **700** “weedless” while the body **102** is in a non-deformed state.

(33) As discussed above, the stays **570**, **572** of the hook assembly **500** spring outward within the interior volume **208** of the hollow body **102** to maintain the hook **530** in an upright position. In one example, the stays **570**, **572** of the hook assembly **500** contact the interior side of the bottom **210** of the hollow body **102**. In one example, the stays **570**, **572** of the hook assembly **500** contact the interior side of the sides of the hollow body **102**. The stays **570**, **572** advantageously keep the hook

**530** from tipping over within the hollow body **102**.
(34) FIG. **10** is an enlarged partial top view of a portion of the hollow body fishing lure **700** illustrated in FIG. **7** showing the point **538** of the single hook **530** disposed within the exemplary weed guard **710**. The weed guard **710** generally includes a plurality of projections **1010** extending from a pad **1012**. The pad **1012** may have any desired shape, and in the example depicted in FIG. **10**, the pad **1012** has a circular shape.
(35) In one example, the plurality of projections **1010** are arranged in rows. The rows of projections **1010** are sufficiently spaced to allow the point **538** of the hook **530** to be received between the projections **1010**. In some examples, the plurality of projections **1010** are arranged in rows and columns. Alternatively, the plurality of projections **1010** may be arranged differently. The plurality of projections **1010** are arranged across the pad **1012** such that at least two projections **1010** are disposed beyond the point **538** of the hook **530** to prevent weeds from fouling the hook **530**.
(36) FIG. **11** is a sectional side view of a portion of the hollow body fishing lure **700** illustrated in FIG. **7** showing the point **538** of the single hook **530** disposed within the projections **1010** of the weed guard **710**. The projections **1010** of the weed guard **710** may be formed from a polymer or other suitable material. Each of projections **1010** includes a shaft **1120** having a proximal end **1124** and a distal end **1122**. The distal end **1122** of the shaft **1120** may include an optional cap **1126**. The cap **1126** has a sectional area larger than a sectional area of the shaft **1120**, such that the cap **1126** overhangs the shaft **1120**. In one example, the cap **1126** may be formed by melting the polymer material from which the projections **1010** were formed. At least two adjacent shafts **1120** have a pitch greater than a diameter **1142** of the hook **530** which allows the hook **530** to be disposed below the cap **1126** among the plurality of projections **1010**. As the sectional area of the caps **1126** is greater than that of the area of the shafts **1120**, the overhanging caps **1126** function to capture the point **538** of the hook **530** among the plurality of projections **1010** which enhances the weed guarding functionality of the weed guard **710**.
(37) Once a bite force (shown by arrow **402**) is applied to the hollow body **102** as shown in FIG. **12**, the hollow body **102** deforms, collapsing inward. As the hollow body **102** collapses inward, the top **126** of the hollow body **102** and the weed guard **710** disposed thereon move away from the point **538** of the single hook **530**, leaving the point **538** exposed clear and above the projections **1010** of the weed guard **710** such that the point **538** of the single hook **530** can freely penetrate the striking fish.
(38) Moreover, even with the hollow body **102** deformed and the point **538** of the single hook **530** free and clear of the weed guard **710**, the stays **570**, **572** continue to support the point **538** of the single hook **530** vertically relative to the hollow body **102** so that the point **538** of the single hook **530** does not rotate to a position where the hollow body **102** can shield the point **538**, but rather the point **538** of the single hook **530** remains in a position clear of the weed guard **710** and the hollow body **102** such that the point **538** of the hook **530** can freely engage the striking fish without obstruction, resulting in higher hook up ratios.
(39) FIG. **13** is a sectional view of one example of the weed guard **710** that may be utilized with a hollow body fishing lure or other type of fishing lure. The weed guard **710** is generally configured as described above with reference to FIGS. **10** and **11**. The weed guard **710** prior to use includes a removable backing **1302** disposed over the adhesive **1110**. The removable backing **1302** may be peeled away or otherwise removed to expose the adhesive **1110** when the weed guard **710** is ready to be attached to the top **136** of the hollow body **102** or other type of fishing lure.
(40) FIG. **14** schematically illustrates a single hook replacement kit **1400** that includes one or more single hook assemblies **500**, and optionally one or more weed guards **710**, disposed in a packaging container **1402**. In the example illustrated in FIG. **14**, three single hook assemblies **500** and five optional weed guards **710** are disposed in the packaging container **1402** of the kit **1400**. In other examples, the single hook replacement kit **1400** may include at least one to as many hook assemblies **500** that may fit within the packaging container **1402**, and between zero to as many

weed guards **710** that can be disposed in the packaging container **1402**. The packaging container **1402** may be a polymer bag, a blister pack, a hinged plastic box, a cardboard box, a paper board box or other suitable container.

(41) FIG. **15** is a side view of another example of a single hook assembly **1500** that may be used as a replacement to a conventional double hook assembly **104** of a conventional hollow body fishing lure **100** illustrated in FIGS. **1-3**, or in a hollow body fishing lure **700** illustrated in FIG. **7**, among others. The single hook assembly **1500** may also be used as an alternative to replace the single hook assembly **500** in the kit **1400**.

(42) The single hook assembly **1500** is generally the same as the hook assembly **500** except herein the single hook assembly **1500** does not utilize a spacer **110**, but rather a single hook **1530** of the hook assembly **1500** has a stepped front portion **1502** disposed between the stays **570**, **572** (only one stay is shown in the side view of FIG. **15**, with the second stay being on the oppose side of the reference plan as described above). The other parts of the single hook **1530** are the same as the hook **530**, including the stays **570**, **572**. The stays **570**, **572** allow the hook **1530** to maintain an upright orientation within the hollow body **102** as described above with reference to the hook **530**.

(43) The stepped front portion **1502** includes a first portion **1504** and a second portion **1506**. The first portion **1504** connects the second portion **1506** to the shank **534** of the hook **1530**. The first portion **1504** generally extends at a 90 degree or greater angle from the shank **534** generally in the same but opposite direction as the bend **536**, as shown in FIG. **15**. The second portion **1506** connects the first portion **1504** to the eye **532** of the hook **1530**. The second portion **1506** is substantially parallel to the shank **534** of the hook **1530**, and a length sufficient to pass through the aperture **112** disposed in the front **114** of the hollow body **102** (shown in phantom), thus retaining the position of the hook **1530** within the hollow body **102**.

(44) Thus, a single hook assembly having stays that allow a hook to be maintained in an desirable orientation that promotes in provided hook up ratios has been disclosed above. The single hook assembly can be effortlessly installed through an aperture of the hollow body, easily replacing conventional double hook assemblies. An adhesive backed weed guard has also been disclosed that can be readily mounted on the exterior of a lure. The weed guard may optionally be included with the single hook assembly as part of a replacement kit. The single hook assembly may also be utilized as original equipment on lures seeking to improve penetration over double hook designs.

(45) While the foregoing is directed to embodiments of the present disclosure, other and further embodiments of the disclosure may be devised without departing from the basic scope thereof, and the scope thereof is determined by the claims that follow.

## Claims

1. A replaceable single hook assembly for replacing a hook in a hollow body fishing lure having a front hole and a rear hole, the replaceable single hook assembly consisting essentially of: a single hook having a shank terminating at an eye, a bend connecting the shank to a point, the bend and the shank both residing in a first reference plane, the shank having a sufficient length to extend through the front hole while the bend or the shank extends through the rear hole; a spacer having a first eye and a second eye connected by a link, the first eye connected to the eye of the hook a first stay having an elongated body, the elongated body having a first end connected to the single hook and a second end extending away from the shank towards the bend of the single hook, the elongated body disposed on a first side of the first reference plane, the elongated body having sufficient resiliency to substantially return to an original position of the elongated body within an interior cavity of the hollow body fishing lure after deflecting the second end against the single hook upon passing through the rear hole of the hollow body fishing lure; and a second stay having an elongated body, the elongated body of the second stay having a first end connected to the single hook and a second end extending away from the shank towards the bend of the single hook, the elongated body of the

second stay disposed on a second side of the first reference plane, the elongated body of the second stay having sufficient resiliency to substantially return to an original position of the elongated body of the second stay within an interior cavity of the hollow body fishing lure after deflecting the second end of the second stay against the single hook upon passing through the rear hole of the hollow body fishing lure.

2. The replaceable single hook assembly of claim 1, wherein the first stay and the second stay are symmetrical relative to the first reference plane.

3. The replaceable single hook assembly of claim 2, wherein the first stay and the second stay form an arrow shape.

4. The replaceable single hook assembly of claim 1, wherein the first stay and the second stay are sufficiently rigid to support the first reference plane of the single hook assembly in a substantially vertical orientation when the first and second stays are placed on a horizontal surface with the point disposed over the shank of the single hook.

5. The replaceable single hook assembly of claim 4, wherein the first stay and the second stay have an orientation perpendicular to the first reference plane of the single hook assembly.

6. The replaceable single hook assembly of claim 4, wherein the second ends of the first and second stays are disposed on a side of a second reference plane that is opposite the point of the single hook, the second reference plane having an orientation perpendicular to the first reference plane, the shank residing in both the first and second reference planes.

7. The replaceable single hook assembly of claim 4, wherein the second ends of the first and second stays do not extend beyond a total length of the single hook when deflected against the single hook.

8. The replaceable single hook assembly of claim 4, wherein the second ends of the first and second stays do extend past a barb of the single hook when deflected against the single hook.

9. The replaceable single hook assembly of claim 4, wherein the second ends of the first and second stays do not overlap the bend of the single hook when deflected against the single hook.

10. The replaceable single hook assembly of claim 1, wherein the single hook has a size from 1/0 to 6/0.

11. A hollow body fishing lure hook replacement kit comprising: a packaging container; and the replaceable single hook assembly of claim 1 disposed in the packaging container.

12. The hollow body fishing lure hook replacement kit of claim 11 further comprising: an adhesive backed weed guard disposed in the container, the adhesive backed weed guard comprising: a pad; a plurality of projections extending a distance from a first side of the pad, the distance being at least half a diameter of the shank and less than 2.5 times the diameter of the shank; an adhesive disposed on a second side of the pad; and a peel-away backing disposed over the adhesive.

13. A replaceable single hook assembly, consisting essentially of: a single hook having a shank terminating at an eye, a bend connecting the shank to a point, the bend and the shank both residing in a first reference plane, the single hook has a size from 2/0 to 6/0; a spacer having a first eye and a second eye connected by a link, the first eye connected to the eye of the hook; a first stay having an elongated body, the elongated body having a first end connected to the single hook and a second end extending away from the shank towards the bend of the single hook, the elongated body disposed on a first side of the first reference plane, the elongated body having sufficient resiliency to substantially return to an original position of the elongated body after deflecting the second end against the single hook; and a second stay having an elongated body, the elongated body of the second stay having a first end connected to the single hook and a second end extending away from the shank towards the bend of the single hook, the elongated body of the second stay disposed on a second side of the first reference plane, the elongated body of the second stay having sufficient resiliency to substantially return to an original position of the elongated body of the second stay after deflecting the second end of the second stay against the single hook, the first stay and the second stay are symmetrical relative to the first reference plane, wherein the first stay and the

second stay are sufficiently rigid to support the first reference plane of the single hook assembly in a substantially vertical orientation when the first and second stays are placed on a horizontal surface with the point disposed over the shank of the single hook, and wherein the second ends of the first and second stays do not extend past a barb of the single hook when deflected against the single hook.

14. The replaceable single hook assembly of claim 13, wherein the first and second stays are fabricated from a polymer, each of the first and second stays having a sectional area greater than or equal to a sectional area of the shank.

15. A hollow body fishing lure hook replacement kit comprising: a packaging container; and the replaceable single hook assembly of claim 13 disposed in the packaging container.

16. The hollow body fishing lure hook replacement kit of claim 15 further comprising: an adhesive backed weed guard disposed in the container, the adhesive backed weed guard comprising: a pad; a plurality of projections extending a distance from a first side of the pad, the distance being at least half a diameter of the shank and less than 2.5 times the diameter of the shank; an adhesive disposed on a second side of the pad; and a peel-away backing disposed over the adhesive.

17. The hollow body fishing lure hook replacement kit of claim 16, wherein each of the plurality of projections of the adhesive backed weed guard further comprises: a proximal end coupled to a distal end by an elongated shaft, the proximal end coupled to the pad, the distal end having a cap that overhangs the shaft.

18. The hollow body fishing lure hook replacement kit of claim 17, wherein the cap has a sectional area greater than a sectional area of the shaft of the projection.

19. A replaceable single hook assembly for replacing a hook in a hollow body fishing lure, the replaceable single hook assembly consisting essentially of: a single hook having a shank terminating at an eye, a bend connecting the shank to a point, the bend and the shank both residing in a first reference plane; a spacer having a first eye and a second eye connected by a link, the first eye connected to the eye of the hook a first stay having an elongated body, the elongated body having a first end connected to the single hook and a second end extending away from the shank towards the bend of the single hook, the elongated body disposed on a first side of the first reference plane; and a second stay having an elongated body, the elongated body of the second stay having a first end connected to the single hook and a second end extending away from the shank towards the bend of the single hook, the elongated body of the second stay disposed on a second side of the first reference plane, wherein the first stay and the second stay form an arrow shape.

20. The replaceable single hook assembly of claim 19, wherein: the first stay and the second stay have an orientation perpendicular to the first reference plane of the single hook assembly, and are sufficiently rigid to support the first reference plane of the single hook assembly in a substantially vertical orientation when the first and second stays are placed on a horizontal surface with the point disposed over the shank of the single hook.

21. The replaceable single hook assembly of claim 20, wherein the second ends of the first and second stays do not extend beyond a total length of the single hook when deflected against the single hook.